

Paul Ritter

Executive Summary

Infrastructure and cybersecurity leader with 20+ years of experience designing, securing, and operating enterprise technology environments in higher education, aviation, and managed services. Proven success leading infrastructure modernization, disaster recovery, cybersecurity incident response, cloud adoption, and enterprise architecture initiatives. Experienced in building high-performing technical teams and aligning technology investments with organizational objectives.

Core Competencies

Infrastructure: VMware, Hyper-V, SAN Storage, Disaster Recovery, Business Continuity

Cloud: Azure, AWS, Azure Data Factory, Azure Data Lake, Microsoft 365

Networking & Security: Palo Alto, Fortinet, Cisco, Firewalls, NAC, Vulnerability Management, Incident Response, IAM

Data & Analytics: SQL Server, Oracle, Power BI, Tableau, Azure Synapse Analytics, Data Warehousing

Leadership: Vendor Management, Strategic Planning, Budgeting, Project Management

Experience

Nov 2023 – Present Northern Ky University Highland Heights, KY

Associate Director, Infrastructure

- Direct four infrastructure teams responsible for enterprise networking, telephony, server, and application platforms supporting university operations.
- Architect and implement disaster recovery plans and procedures for all infrastructure systems.
- Evaluate and implement both incident responses and vulnerability assessment recommendations to improve University security posture.
- Lead the selection and implementation of cloud-based solutions to modernize enterprise voice, security cameras, and environmental sensors across the campus.
- Modernized University infrastructure standards to reduce physical cabling, resulting in a 30% infrastructure cost reduction for construction and renovation projects.
- Served as Operations Commander during multiple cybersecurity incidents, coordinating cross-functional response efforts, directing containment and recovery activities, and ensuring timely communication with executive leadership and stakeholders.
- Established long-term cloud adoption and multi-cloud strategies to improve scalability, resiliency, and operational efficiency while optimizing resource utilization and costs.
- Partner with university leadership, vendors, and technical teams to align infrastructure investments with institutional objectives and emerging technology needs.

Dec 2019 – Oct 2023 Wheels Up

Erlanger, KY

Data Engineer

- Collaborate with cybersecurity and network teams to establish connectivity between business data source systems and Azure Data Lake Storage services.
- Design and implement Azure Data Factory pipelines to move raw data from business application databases and web APIs into Azure Data Lake Storage.
- Work with business stakeholders to create data models to answer complex analytics questions.
- Serve as the subject matter expert for flight operations, aircraft maintenance, workforce management, and CRM data domains.
- Establish and maintain data governance policies and procedures, including GDPR right to erasure.
- Act as the subject matter expert for all IT infrastructure and business applications at the CVG office.

Dec 2017 – Dec 2019 Delta Private Jets

Erlanger, KY

Business Intelligence Developer

- Coordinate with other business units to define and understand business requirements related to additions and enhancements to the existing data warehouse.
- Create and maintain ETL processes with SQL Server Integration Services to ensure accurate and timely data delivery.
- Create and maintain reports and visualizations in Tableau, SQL Server Reporting Services, Crystal Reports, and Power BI for scheduled and on-demand reporting.
- Act as the primary administrator for all the Business Intelligence infrastructure, including MS SQL servers, database SAN storage, iSCSI storage fabric, and Tableau server.

April 2015 – Dec 2017 Global Business Solutions

Newport, KY

Senior Systems Engineer

- Provide a single point of contact for all IT support, from desktop issues to multi-site network connectivity, to over 20 business clients in the region.
- Recommend remediation actions for infrastructure, data security, and financial audits.
- Plan and deploy user security training and assessment to business clients and prepare executive summaries based on assessment results.
- Architect and implement modernization projects for client network and server architecture.
- Manage project milestones and oversee project team members for various network, telephone, and server system upgrade and installation projects.
- Provide senior-level mentoring to junior engineers and subject-matter expertise to other senior engineers.
- Work with business leadership to develop new product offerings.

July 2014 – April 2015 Tracker Products

Erlanger, KY

Full-Stack Developer / Scrum Master

- Provide leadership to the Scrum development team.

- Interface with product owners and stakeholders to discover software requirements and define acceptance criteria.
- Architect, develop, and test SQL, C# Web API and AngularJS code for new product development.
- Design and implement scalable AWS services to host SaaS products.

June 2011 – July 2014 Northern Ky University Highland Heights, KY

Lead Systems Analyst

- Provide technical leadership and supervision to infrastructure staff.
- Design, implement, and maintain a VMware environment consisting of 22 ESX hosts in 3 different datacenters hosting over 250 virtual machines, including P2V conversion of existing servers.
- Led a project to convert 100,000+ student email accounts from Microsoft Live@EDU to Office 365.
- Designed and implemented IAM rules to implement campus identity policies.
- Act as the primary administrator for disaster recovery and business continuity.

Sep 2005 – June 2011 Northern Ky University Highland Heights, KY

Lead Technical Support Specialist

- Responsible for Level III technical support of IT services and server-based applications.
- Plan, design, implement, and maintain large-scale server and application solutions with an emphasis on increasing level of service while decreasing administrative overhead.
- Led a project to design, plan, implement, and maintain a VMware server cluster and associated SAN storage. Planning included a strategy to convert physical servers to virtual servers hosted on the cluster.

Education

Master of Business Administration (MBA), Business Analytics & Cybersecurity

Northern Kentucky University, 2025

Master of Computer Science (In Progress)

Expected December 2026

B.S. Computer Science & Mathematics

Northern Kentucky University, 2006